

TRADIEBOT

Business Partner. Never Sleeps.

Product Vision Synthesis | March 2026

01 THE PROBLEM WE'RE SOLVING

The Core Truth

The gap between being a great tradie and running a great trade business is enormous — and nobody is bridging it.

Solo operators are forced to become bookkeepers, project managers, customer service reps, procurement officers and marketers overnight. None of that is what they trained for. None of it is what they're good at. And all of it happens between the actual work.

What This Looks Like In Real Life

A solo tradie finishes a job at 3pm, hands dirty, exhausted. He still has to:

- Write up the invoice
- Reply to two quote requests sitting in his email
- Figure out if he has enough materials for tomorrow
- Text the client to confirm tomorrow's start time
- Log what he used on today's job

That's 90 minutes of unpaid desk work after a full physical day. Every single day.

What The Research Confirms

Poor cash flow is the leading cause of trade business failure in Australia — not lack of work, but broken systems around money, invoicing and administration. Many tradies delay invoicing until late at night or the weekend, and over a year this costs them the equivalent of an entire month's cashflow.

02 THE MARKET LANDSCAPE

Who Already Exists

The main players in Australia are ServiceM8, Tradify, Fergus and Simpro. All are established, all have paying customers, and all share the same fundamental flaw.

ServiceM8	Mobile-first, strong for small teams managing multiple jobs. iOS focused.
Tradify	Popular all-rounder. Simple, easy to use. Weak on reporting and automation.
Fergus	Strong on job costing and financial control. No team communication features at all.
Simpro	Best for larger operations. Too complex for solo operators.

The Critical Gap They All Share

Every single one of these tools is reactive. The tradie has to go in, enter something, ask something, do something. The software sits there waiting.

None of them have meaningful AI. None of them are proactive. None of them learn. None of them work while the tradie sleeps.

They digitised the paperwork. They didn't eliminate the thinking.

03 THE PRODUCT VISION

The One-Line Vision

Give every solo tradie in Australia the same intelligent business support that only large companies can currently afford.

The Product Philosophy

This is not software. This is a business partner that never sleeps.

The AI works passively in the background — reading emails, scanning invoices, watching schedules, monitoring supplier prices, analysing job history. The tradie does nothing different. The AI learns from how they already operate and gets smarter every single day.

The design principle is radical simplicity:

The tradie sees almost nothing. The AI does almost everything.

What Makes This Different From Everything Else

- **Passive input** — the AI feeds itself from existing data, no manual entry required
- **Proactive output** — it comes to the tradie with information, not the other way around
- **Personalised intelligence** — every tradie's experience is completely unique to them
- **Always running** — working overnight while the tradie sleeps
- **Compounding value** — gets smarter every single day, becomes irreplaceable over time

04 THE MAGIC MOMENT

The Hook That No Competitor Has

The first experience isn't an onboarding wizard. It isn't a tutorial. It isn't a dashboard asking for data entry.

It's a free Business Health Diagnosis. The tradie connects their email and bank account. The AI analyses everything in 60 seconds. It comes back with something like this:

Hey Marco. Noticed something — you've done 11 jobs in the Hills District this year. Your average job there is \$4,400 and you've been paid within 9 days every time. But you're spending most of your time taking \$1,800 jobs in Blacktown that take 6 weeks to get paid. You're working twice as hard for half the money. Want me to help you shift that?

Marco has never seen that. His accountant has never told him that. No software has ever told him that.

That is the magic moment. The AI knows something about his business that he didn't know himself — and it's right.

That moment — in the first 60 seconds — is what makes him call three other tradies immediately.

05 THE USER EXPERIENCE

Design Philosophy

The target user is a skeptical, time-poor tradie who tried Tradify once and lasted two weeks. The interface must feel like texting a smart mate — not using enterprise software.

Think WhatsApp, not Xero. Think conversation, not dashboard. Think three taps maximum to act on anything.

The Daily Morning Brief

Every morning the tradie opens one screen. It looks like a message thread from a smart business partner. Example:

Morning Marco. Big day — Kellyville job starts at 8, client confirmed. Copper pipe is \$23 cheaper at Reece Bella Vista today vs your usual. Want me to reserve it for pickup on the way? Also: invoice from the Henderson job is 14 days overdue. Want me to follow that up? One thing needs you: new quote request came in Saturday night. I've drafted a response — takes 30 seconds to review.

The tradie makes three micro-decisions. Yes, yes, review. Back in the ute. Day running. Everything else happened without him.

The Trust Progression

The product never asks for more trust than it has earned. Access is granted in stages:

Level 1 — Read Only	Email and calendar scanning. AI observes and reports. Cannot touch anything.
Level 2 — Suggest & Approve	AI drafts actions, tradie approves each one. Quote drafts, invoice reminders, price comparisons.
Level 3 — Autonomous Routines	Routine tasks the tradie has approved enough times. Runs automatically, tradie notified after.
Level 4 — Full Partnership	Proactive business development, market analysis, financial forecasting, network coordination.

06 THE PASSIVE LEARNING ENGINE

How The AI Gets Smarter

The intelligence compounds over time. The more the tradie simply lives their normal working life, the smarter the AI becomes — without them doing anything differently.

Week 1	Orientation. Reads all available data. Builds a map of how this person operates.
Month 1	Pattern recognition. Identifies rhythms, recurring clients, pricing habits, slow payers.
Month 3	Predictive intelligence. Anticipates problems and opportunities before they happen.
Year 1	Full business partner. Knows their business better than they do.

The Compounding Moat

After 6 months of passive learning, the AI holds 6 months of deeply personalised business intelligence. That data cannot be replicated by a competitor overnight.

The switching cost isn't money. It's irreplaceable intelligence. That is the product's long-term competitive moat.

07 TARGET CUSTOMER

Who We're Building For First

Solo operators and 1-2 person trade businesses in Sydney. This is the most underserved segment in the market — too small for enterprise tools, too busy for complex software, and completely without the business support infrastructure that larger companies take for granted.

Business size	1-2 person operation
Location	Sydney metro (initial focus)
Tech comfort	Uses smartphone daily but skeptical of new apps
Current tools	WhatsApp, maybe Xero, probably a notebook
Core pain	No time, no admin support, flying blind on business performance
What they want	More time on the tools, less time on the business

08 FOUNDING TEAM & UNFAIR ADVANTAGES

Why This Team Can Build This

- Real trade experience — 3 years at Bau Group, deep personal network of solo operators
- 5 real test users already identified — not beta testers, co-builders
- Step-father with PhD in business architecture — enterprise-level system design capability
- Brother with software engineering background — build capacity in-house
- Industry relationships — word of mouth go-to-market is already seeded

The 'Do Things That Don't Scale' Strategy

Before the AI does it automatically, the founders do it manually. The first 5 tradie users experience the product as it's meant to feel — with the founders acting as the AI behind the scenes, learning exactly what information matters, building the automated version to replicate it precisely.

09 BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT COMES FIRST

The MVP: One Experience, Done Perfectly

The entire first version of the product is built around delivering the magic moment in the first 60 seconds — the Business Health Diagnosis.

Required Integrations For Day One Value

Gmail / Outlook API	Scans email for unread quotes, invoices, client threads
ABN Lookup	Instantly pulls business registration details, trading history
Xero API	Read-only access to invoices, payments, cash flow
Bank feed (optional)	Passive financial monitoring without accounting software

Four data connections. Four integrations. Enough to deliver a genuinely intelligent first experience that no competitor can match.

What We Are NOT Building In Version One

- Procurement engine
- Trade network / referral system
- Inventory management
- Full job management system
- Marketing tools

All of those come later, layered on top of the trusted foundation. Version one is the magic moment and the morning brief. Nothing else.

10 KNOWN WEAKNESSES — EYES OPEN

Challenges To Solve

Cold start problem	AI has no data on day one. Solved by the Business Health Diagnosis using existing data the tradie already has.
Supplier API access	Procurement features require supplier partnerships. Deprioritised for version one.

Behaviour change	Even simple products face adoption resistance. Solved by making value visible within 60 seconds of signup.
AI running costs	Continuous background agents are expensive at scale. Pricing model must account for compute costs from the start.
Incumbents copying	ServiceM8 and Tradify could bolt on AI. Moat must be data depth and personalisation, not just features.

11 THE NORTH STAR

The solo tradie wakes up. Opens the app. The AI has been working all night. In 30 seconds he knows exactly where his business stands, what needs his attention today, and what opportunity he would have missed. He taps twice. Gets in the ute. The business is already running.

That is the product. That is the mission. That is what nobody has ever built for this person before.